If you take anything with you at all from this last section, I hope you'll remember the following:

- Sometime in the next month, year, or three years, the market will decline sharply.
- Market declines are great opportunities to buy stocks in companies you like. Corrections—Wall Street's definition of going down a lot—push outstanding companies to bargain prices.
- Trying to predict the direction of the market over one year, or even two years, is impossible.
- To come out ahead you don't have to be right all the time, or even a majority of the time.
- The biggest winners are surprises to me, and takeovers are even more surprising. It takes years, not months, to produce big results.
- Different categories of stocks have different risks and rewards.
- You can make serious money by compounding a series of 20–30 percent gains in stalwarts.
- Stock prices often move in opposite directions from the fundamentals but long term, the direction and sustainability of profits will prevail.
- Just because a company is doing poorly doesn't mean it can't do worse.
- Just because the price goes up doesn't mean you're right.
- Just because the price goes down doesn't mean you're wrong.
- Stalwarts with heavy institutional ownership and lots of Wall Street coverage that have outperformed the market and are overpriced are due for a rest or a decline.
- Buying a company with mediocre prospects just because the stock is cheap is a losing technique.
- Selling an outstanding fast grower because its stock seems slightly overpriced is a losing technique.
- Companies don't grow for no reason, nor do fast growers stay that way forever.
- You don't lose anything by not owning a successful stock, even if it's a tenbagger.
- A stock does not know that you own it.
- Don't become so attached to a winner that complacency sets in and you stop monitoring the story.